EZ Rack

Partner

Provider Manual

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Section 1: Overview

EZ Rack rents reusable racks and shelving that ride on standard wooden pallets. A "rack" consists of corner posts (CP7), double riveted steel beams (DRB) and wood shelving, and the racks are either gray, dark gray, silver vein, black metal or white. EZ Rack's rental customers are Plant Nurseries (Nursery Farms) who sell to retail garden centers such as Home Depot and Lowes. The racks are shipped from regional packaging centers to the Nurseries, who use the racks to transport plants to their customers. Once empty, racks are staged outside of the retailer's garden centers, and the regional packaging centers. Once staged we send out drivers for their collection. The drivers disassemble the racks on site, record the quantity of each rack component using the Pickup BOL then repackage the disassembled rack and return them to the designated location (warehouse, storage facility). Upon return to the packaging center, rack components are prepped and palletized for shipment to another Nursery rental customer.

Section 2: Rack Pick-Up Process

1. The driver arrives on-site at the retailer.
2. VERIFY the retailer's address matches the store you are located.
3. ENSURE checking in with retailers at IGC and Big Box retailers other than HD and LO.
4. Separate EZ Rack materials, unlabeled white rack and black rack from racks labeled with a Nursery's name.
5. Count all racks to be recovered by Tier. Count each color rack separately, Rental (silver vein and black with green tips and EZ Rack stickers), white, and un-labeled black. Components will be repackaged separately. Rental is defined as silver vein and black with green tips and EZ rack stickers.
6. DO NOT pick up the used shelving, OSB or 8 over 3 Lath. Only recover EZ Rack shelving.
7. DO NOT pick up racks that are labeled with a Nursery's name. If a Nursery's rack contains gray or silver vein components, take the gray and silver vein components, and leave the remaining components behind. Leftover components should be placed on a pallet.
8. DO NOT pick up rolling racks.
9. Disassemble racks on site.
10. Recover any EZ Rack components, even if they are part of a non-EZ Rack set up.
11. Clean the store's rack area by stacking empty pallets and picking up large debris.
12. DO NOT pick up extra pallets unless specifically instructed to do so by your manager.
13. Recover all components associated with EZ Rack. DO NOT leave any damaged or broken components behind, but account for all within your BOL component counts.
14. Complete all documentation, instructions per Section 5.2 in Pickup Bill of Lading.

Section 3: Obligation

1. Individuals must conduct themselves in a professional manner with all customers and while representing Reusability.
2. The work area will be left clean and organized when the driver leaves any retailer.
3. Leftover Pallets should be stacked neatly in the recovery area. Maximum pallet height is 6' (six feet) to limit tip-over hazards.

4. Before leaving the store, pick up any trash from the area and stack the trash beside the stack of pallets.
5. EZ Rack Apparel (vest, etc.) must always be worn when representing the company.
6. DO NOT remove any material from retailer other than what is specifically detailed in this document. Carrier must fill out required documentation before leaving a facility in its' entirety as detailed in this document.

Section 4: Breakdown and Disassembly of Rack

1. Park the truck as close as possible to the racks to reduce walking.
2. Remove wood shelving and stack them on a pallet.
3. Tip the rack over so it is lying on its 48" side to prevent damage.
4. Using a mallet, tap the 48" DRBs (Double Rivet Beams) on top to separate them from the corner posts. Stack the DRBs and corner posts in a bin or on a pallet.
5. Tap and remove the remaining 40" CPs (Corner Post), as they will be stuck up unsupported.
6. Turn over the bottom 48" DRBs and CPs while applying light pressure with your foot. Tap the 48" DRBs free from the bottom CPs.
7. Place all components on to separate pallets or in separate bins.
8. Smaller Vehicles (16' Box and smaller) assembled racks will not be able to stand up inside the vehicle. Never bend the corner posts to make them fit.
9. DO NOT bend or damage metal components during disassembly. Use only plastic or rubber mallets.
10. DO NOT mix component SKU. Each component is stored on its own pallet.

Section 4.1: Required Supply Checklist

Material	**Documentation**
Saftey Vest/Safety Cone	Pickup BOL
Leather Gloves	Driver Authorization Letter
Mallet – Rubber or Plastic	Documents – Required by State or Fed
Pallet Jack	
Claw Hammer	
Rachet Straps	
Banding Equipment	

Section 4.2: Pickup Bill of Lading (BOL)

1. The top section of the BOL describes what location is to be serviced and by what provider.
2. The middle section of the BOL identifies who shipped, received, and hauled the order.
   - For recoveries, the driver will print their name, sign, and date in the Received By section.
3. The bottom section of the BOL identifies the Items/SKUs and quantities to be recovered from the location.
   - Record total quantity of Gray/Silver Vein, white, and black pieces in the Qty PU box to the right of Item Qty on the BOL. Record each type of component separately. Assure that all EZ Rack shelves used for the Corner Post pallets are also accounted for . See section 6.1.
   - Pickups are completed during store hours.

Section 4.3: Rack Break Down Video

https://ezrack-my.sharepoint.com/:v:/g/personal/apoirier_reusability_com/ERZpfrL5NchMnHPc-g9MfTQBJILiLDpUzv4UBVsCj7bcHA?e=BmiI5X

Section 5: Quality Assurance & Repair of Components:

Repack material per component and per color, Rental (Silver Vein and black with green tips and EZ Rack stickers), white, and black.

White racks have two types of light duty and economy. Economy is narrower than light duty and will need to be repackaged separately of the white light duty.

1. Light duty DRB 2.5" Height
2. Economy DRB 2.0" Height

The Standard Quality conditions of Metal Components are defined Herein:

1. **WIP -** Straight, no repair required, and ready for repackaging.
2. **Damaged -** Straightening required prior to repackaging; repair with press.
    a. To repair for a later time, report as **repair** in RMS. Any material left in "damaged" status over 30 days will require pictures and written documentation.
3. **Scrap -** Damaged beyond repair, report as **scrap** in RMS. Scrap may only be disposed of via the Scrap Disposal Process, Section 9.

Note: While accumulating Damaged Metal Components, keep the material physically separated from Scrap. Use the press to repair accumulated components periodically vs. stopping repackaging operations to repair each piece.

Section 5.1: Examples of Component Condition

- **The following section details whether components are repairable, or scrap based on pictorial graphics and narrative shown below.**

DRB's = Repairable

With moderate bends in both DRB's they can be placed in the metal press and returned to functional status. This process may require multiple passes thorough the press and use of a rubber or plastic mallet. This type of damage generally happens during transportation while fully assembled and loaded with plants.

DRB's = Scrap

In the first example the DRB is missing a rivet. This damage occurs primarily during the assembly of the rack by the grower. Missing rivets are not a repairable item. The second example is bent beyond the ability of the hydraulic press or mallet to correct.

CP7's = Repairable

With slight bends in both Corner Posts the Material **CAN** be placed in the metal press and returned to functional status. This process may require multiple passes through the press and use of a rubber or plastic mallet. This type of damage generally happens during transportation of the rack while fully assembled and loaded with plants.

CP7's = Scrap

This damage occurs mainly during loading and unloading the rack and relocation for display by the retail location. Both examples **CAN NOT** be repaired by the Material press or mallet and are considered scrap.

Reminder: Keep viable material physically separated from Scrap. Use the metal press periodically to repair accumulated components versus stopping to repair each piece.

Section 6: Repackaging Procedure

WARNING Pay strict attention to the repackaging process, the guidelines set forth in this manual have been created to assure optimal shipping and receiving of Rack material. Any variation of repackaging that is not in this SOP is prohibited.

All component processing performed at the provider's location will have to be updated concurrently in RMS by day end.

Section 6.1: Repackaging Corner Post

1. Rental (silver vein and black with green tips and EZ Rack stickers), solid black, and white components must be repackaged and accounted for separately. Look closely as older silver vein components may appear black at first glance. Never mix multi colored corner posts silver vein and black with green tips . Solid black or white CPs must be separated on their own pallets .
2. Place a sturdy 48”x 40” pallet on the worktable (stack of pallets) with the 40” direction facing you. Do not use junk pallets that may not handle the weight of a finished pallet when stacked and stored.
    a. **Note:** Do not use **Blue CHEP** or **Red PECO** pallets for any repackaging.
3. Use a Finished Goods only piece of 4 over 10 EZ Rack piece shelving to cover the top of the pallet so that the pallet surface is level. Turn the shelf upside-down, so that the 4 bottom stringers are facing up for a leveled pallet surface. Place the first stack of 10 CP7s on the pallet, in the shape of a cone ^.
4. One Finished Goods EZ Rack Shelf per corner post pallet only (in example below)! Do not use additional EZ Rack shelving on top of the Finished Goods Corner Post pallet.

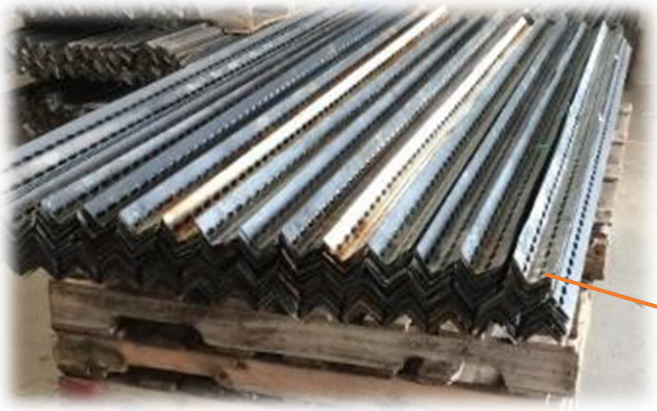
5. Leave a 3/4” space between the first stack of CP7s and the edge of the pallet to allow for banding. Continue placing the CP7 stacks on the pallet, making sure the stacks of 10 are

tight against each other, until you have 16 stacks of 10 corner posts on the first layer. Once you have the first row of CP's complete , start the second row and place an additional 15 stacks of 10 with the cone facing down ∨, Finally on the last row place 9 stacks of 10 with the cone facing up ∧ spread evenly across the center of the pallet to balance the weight As you build the FG pallet Place Corner Posts, so an equal amount hangs off each side of the pallet.

6. If done properly, there will be a ½" to ¾" gap between the first and last row on the pallet.
7. This completes the bottom row of corner posts.

Example: Corner Post REPACKAGING

First row of 16 with the cone facing up



Second row placed cone down.

Section 6.2: Processing of Finished Pallet

1. Banding Minimum Requirement:
    a. Poly Banding: 5/8" width and at least 500lbs break strength.
    b. Steel Banding: 1/2" width
2. Use two bands minimum to secure the CP7s on the pallet.
3. Both bands are placed and tightened on the inside of the pallet stringer.
4. Attach a pallet tag to the top of a band and mark it with the total number of corner posts on that pallet, your city. Pallet tag example:

a. Component and Quantity **CP7 400**
b. Repackage Code **EZLAFL**
c. Date of pallet creation **1/1/24**

Creating Finished Pallets of Less Than Standard Configuration – Corner Posts

1. Outbound shipments of finished pallets to Growers will often require CP7 quantities that are not multiples of 400 to fulfill the order.
2. Odd quantity finished pallets can be quantities of 100, 200, or 300 CPs.
   a. 100 Count Pallet 10 stacks of 10 on a single layer.
   b. 200 Count Pallet 11 stacks of 10 on the bottom layer and 9 stacks of 10 on the second layer.
   c. 300 Count Pallet 16 stacks of 10 on the bottom layer and 14 stacks of 10 on the second layer.
3. Providers can wait to build an odd quantity pallet until the load calls for one or create one of each, report as Finished Goods in RMS, and hold in storage until a load requires a pallet with less than 400 CPs.

Section 6.3: Double Rivet Beams (DRB) Repackaging: 40” & 48”

1. The Standard Finished Pallet quantity is 600 DRBs.
2. Never use EZ Rack shelving as a securement method or in the repackaging of DRB’s!!
3. Outbound shipment quantities sometimes call for quantities that are not in multiples of 600.
4. Drivers must return DRBs to the warehouse segregated from other component sizes. This avoids sorting components in the warehouse and speeds up processing.
5. Create two WIP DRB repackaging stations in the warehouse. One each for 40”and 48” DRBs. Create a repack table using a stack of pallets approximately waist high to improve worker comfort. Use this table to create finished pallets.
6. Use zip ties to bundle outside stacks of DRBs on each later for stability.
7. For the top level: Use 2 DRB’s from the pallet for the outside edges to ensure proper securement during the banding process. (see example below) DRB’s used for this purpose

must be from the current pallet being repackaged not in addition to (example-2 from a Finished goods pallet of 600. NOT 602).

8. Create a bin to accumulate Repairable and Scrap DRBs. Update the repairable and scrap inventory in the RMS daily.
9. Black and white components should be repackaged separately from rental (silver vein/gray and black with green tips and EZ Rack stickers) components.
    a. **Note:** Faded Silver Vein components can appear black, so look closely. Faded silver veins do not get repacked as black.
    b. **Note:** When repackaging white DRBs be mindful of the size variance between light duty and economy, repackage separately.
10. Pallet Tags must be affixed to finished pallets to identify DRB quantity, yard location, and date. The date must be applied at time of shipping.
11. .
12. Consumables including tags, zip ties, vests and blank gray labels are supplied by EZRack via Chris Sweeney csweeney@ezrack.com.

Section 6.4: Repackaging of Beams – Typical 40" And 48" Length

1. Place a sturdy 48"x 40" pallet on the worktable with the 48" direction facing you.
2. **WARNING** Do not use junk pallets as they could crush under the weight finished pallets.
    a. Put 5 DRBs together with the lip facing up and toward you and 5 more DRBs with the lip facing down and away from you and combine. Each stack must consist of 10 DRB.
3. Zip tie lock is positioned on the slanted part of the stack. This maintains flat stacks of DRB.

Section 6.5: Beam Stacking configuration

First Layer:

1. Position the first stack of 10 DRBs along the 48” side of the pallet positioned on one end of the pallet, even with the edge leaving a gap on the other end. The lip of the 5 bottom DRBs on the first stack should face upward and toward the outside of the pallet. See picture above
2. The second stack of 10 DRBs is placed on the pallet with the lip of the 5 bottom DRBs facing upward and toward the inside of the pallet. Place the second stack of 10 DRBs tightly next to the first stack of 40” DRBs. If done properly, the 2 stacks of 10 DRBs will form an A shape between them. Duplicate this process and alternate the lip placement of the DRBs until you have 10 stacks of 10 DRBs, or a total of 100 DRBs per layer.
    a. **Note:** Only the two outside stacks need to be zip-tied. The eight inside stacks on each layer do not need to be zip tied.

Continued Layers:

1. Finish the second layer the same way that you finished the first to complete a std pallet of DRBs continue alternating the direction of the stacks by layer for the 3rd, 4th, 5th, and 6th layers of 100 DRBs. This will result in 600 components on the pallet.

Section 6.6: Creating Finished Pallets of Less Than 600 DRBs

1. Outbound shipments of finished pallets to Growers will often require DRB quantities that are not multiples of 600 to fulfill the total quantity of DRBs ordered.
2. Odd quantity finished pallets can be quantities of 50, 100, 300 or 450 DRBs use the above stacking method to complete the requested quantity.

Section 6.7: Banding and tagging of 40” and 48” DRBs

1. Banding Minimum Requirement
    a. Poly Banding: 5/8” width and at least 500lbs break strength.
    b. Steel Banding: 1/2“width
2. Instead use 2 DRB’s from a FG pallet count of either 600 or 300 (**not additional**) to support the <u>top stack</u> of DRB’s on both side
3. Run the banding through the end of the pallet then up through a gap in the top boards. If run all the way around the pallet the end top board can be pulled out when applying tension to the banding. (See picture below)

4. Ensure the band is aligned with the ends of the DRBs on both sides of the pallet. All bands need to be tight to hold the DRBs in place during transit.
5. Attach a pallet tag to the finished pallet. Pallet tag example and must include the following:
    a. Component and Quantity **DRB40 600**
    b. Location Code **EZLAFL**
    c. Date of pallet creation **1/1/24**
6. Report as **Finished Goods** in RMS.

Note: The placement of banding and tag is important. The tag must be visible if/when another pallet is stacked on top of the existing one.

Section 7: Wood Lath

1. **Only the EZ Rack lath shelving is to be repackaged.** Any other type of shelving found on EZ Rack (OSB – particle board, plywood, and laminate flooring) should be left at the retailer.
    a. An EZ Rack lath shelf has 4 stringers and 10 top boards. All lath shelves align with this standard. Any configuration beyond this standard is not acceptable to repackage.
2. Drivers are encouraged to separate damaged from good shelving when recovering material. This significantly speeds up the repackaging process in the warehouse.
3. Pallet Tags must be affixed to finished pallets to identify Lath quantity, repackage location, and date.
4. **Note:** Stacks of Shelving must be in 50-piece quantities as described below:

Nested Stack of a 50 pc Pallet

Section 7.1: Quality Assurance of 48” x 40” Wood Lath

1. All lath shelves must be inspected to determine the condition of the shelf. Look at it to see if any big chunks of wood are missing, if the shelf is falling apart, or if runners or top boards are significantly thinner than other pieces. The three conditions of shelves are defined as follows:
    a. **WIP** - "Ready for repackaging." If there are not any pieces missing or damaged that a typical potted plant could fall through, and the board thickness is 3/8" or greater than it is good.
    b. **Damaged**- Lath that can be repaired by replacing missing parts taken from other shelves. Only authorized lath repair facilities can use this status.
    c. **Scrap** - Damaged beyond repair or defective. Some lath shelves have below-spec board thickness (less than 3/8") and are considered defective.

Note: Do not dispose of any EZ Rack without obtaining scrap authorization obtained by following the Scrap Disposal Process, Section 9.

Section 7.2: Repackaging of 48" x 40" Wood Shelving

1. Separate scrap/damaged lath from usable while at the pickup to save time at the warehouse and reduce double handling.
2. Stack the wood square on a pallet for faster processing at the warehouse to complete the stack (to a quantity of 50 pieces) and band the stack. Shelving can ONLY be repackaged in nested stacks of 50.
3. Stacks of 50 Shelving must be as square as possible.
    a. **Tip:** Use a warehouse wall, corner, or a support beam to align at least one side of the shelving stack. Uneven stacks will not sit side by side in an outbound trailer.
4. Lath shelves must be alternated side up – side down and nested to reduce the height of a stack. See picture on previous page.

Section 7.3: Banding and Tagging of Shelving

1. Banding Minimum Requirement
    a. Poly Banding 5/8" width and minimum of 500lbs break strength.
    b. Steel Banding 1/2" width

2. Use 2 bands to hold the shelving to the pallet during transit, one each on the inside of the left and right-side pallet stringers in the 48" direction.
3. Attach a pallet tag to the top of a band and mark it with the total number of shelves stacked on the pallet, your location code , and date completed.
4. Process the change from WIP to FG within RMS by day end.
5. Pallet tag example:
    a. Component and Quantity **SHLV 50**
    b. Provider Location Code **EZLAFL**
    c. Date of pallet creation **10.20.2020**

Section 7.4: Stacking and Storage of Finished Goods

1. Stacking and Storage of Finished Good Pallets must comply with the pallet stack limits referenced below. After properly repackaging and banding a pallet of Finished Goods, you may stack the pallets as outlined here to optimize warehouse space:
    a. Corner Posts Not to exceed four (5) pallets. Applies to standard and nonstandard quantities.
    b. Beams (DRB) Not to exceed three (4) pallets. Applies to standard and nonstandard quantities.
    c.
    d. Wood Lath Not to exceed three (3) pallets of 50 (all shelving should be repackaged in quantities of 50 ONLY).
2. All finished shelf pallets stored outdoors must be protected from the rain with a roof. Protective tarps should not be used because they hold in moisture which will cause the steel to rust and wood to rot.

Section 8: Scrap Disposal Authorization and Disposal Policy

1. During the repackaging process, place components that are damaged beyond repair onto separate Scrap pallets and report daily the quantity of Scrap in RMS.
2. Request a scrap disposal authorization when scrap builds up and begins using valuable space. Disposals can be requested at any time.
3. To submit a disposal request, download the Scrap Authorization form from the Document Library, located on the Reusability website.
4. Disposal request emails must have multiple digital pictures of each type of component to be scrapped describing/showing the damaged materials.
5. To request an authorization number, send an email with digital pictures attached to toChris Sweeney at csweeney@ezrack.com with the quantity of each Scrap component requiring disposal.
6. Disposal fees for roll-away bins or dumpsters must be noted in the email for prior written approval by EZ Rack to be awarded. If no disposal fee is noted, Reusability assumes there will be no fee associated and the service provider will not be compensated.

Section 8.1: Email Example

Hi Chris,

Please issue a Scrap Disposal Authorization Number for the following Scrap components:
Corner Posts 176
Lath 85
40" DRB 230
48" DRB 192

There will be a charge of $100.00 to pay a driver to dump the scrap in a landfill.
Thanks,
Joe Re packager

1. EZ Rack will reply and issue a Scrap Disposal Authorization Number approving disposal and cost of disposing scrap components.
2. Once a Scrap Disposal Authorization Number has been issued, execute the disposal.
3. Once complete, the provider must email EZ Rack to have the components removed from their inventory. Only EZ Rack can adjust the inventory after scrap disposal.
4. To be compensated for disposal, the service provider must attach an invoice/receipt copy of the emailed Scrap Disposal Authorization Number and disposal receipt to accounting.
5. **WARNING** Any rack components disposed of without a valid Scrap Disposal Authorization Number will be considered missing from Repackage inventory and replacement costs for each missing component will be enforced per the EZ Rack Service and Rate Agreement.

Section 9: Standard Customer Rack Truckload Quantities Configurations and Weights

1. Ensures even weight distribution across trailer axles and prevents return loads
3. Ensures component pallets brace each other to minimize damage in transport.
4. **DO NOT** Deviate from the loading configurations shown below as they have been established for the Safety of our Partners, Carriers and Customers.

Component Repackaging Quantities and Weights:

Description	Qty/Pallet	Lbs./Piece	Pallet Lbs.
Corner Post	400	5.2	2080
48" DRB	600	3.6	2160
40" DRB	600	3.1	1860
Lath	50	20	1000

Note: Diagram Colors below are consistent with material tags.

300 - 4 LVL RACK WITH BOTTOM LATH			
QTY	Description	Pallets Full	Pallets Partial
1,200	Corner Posts	3	0
2,400	DRB-40	4	0
2,400	DRB-48	4	0
1,200	Wood Lath	24	0
TTL WGT = 42,024 LBS			TTL Pallets 35

300 - 4 LVL RACK WITH NO BOTTOM LATH			
QTY	Description	Pallets Full	Pallets Partial
1,200	Corner Posts	3	0
2,400	DRB-40	4	0
2,400	DRB-48	4	0
900	Wood Lath	18	0
TTL WGT = 36,624 LBS			TTL Pallets 29

NOSE OF TRAILER

NOSE OF TRAILER

350 - 3 LVL RACKS WITH BOTTOM LATH			
QTY	Description	Pallets Full	Pallets Partial
1,400	Corner Posts	3	1
2,100	DRB-40	3	1
2,100	DRB-48	3	1
1,050	Wood Lath	21	0
TTL WGT = 35,528 LBS			TTL Pallets 33

500 - 2 LVL RACKS WITH BOTTOM LATH			
QTY	Description	Pallets Full	Pallets Partial
2,000	Corner Posts	5	0
2,000	DRB-40	3	1
2,000	DRB-48	3	1
1,000	Wood Lath	20	0
TTL WGT = 42,350 LBS			TTL Pallets 33

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250 - 5 LVL RACKS NO BOTTOM LATH			
QTY	Description	Pallets Full	Pallets Partial
1,000	Corner Posts	2	1
2,500	DRB-40	4	1
2,500	DRB-48	4	1
1,000	Wood Lath	20	0
TTL WGT = 33,410 LBS			TTL Pallets 33

NOSE OF TRAILER

Section 10: Safety

1. Adhere to all Provider and EZRack Safety procedures.
2. Adhere to all State and Federal safety regulations.
3. Report any Incidents to Management Immediately.